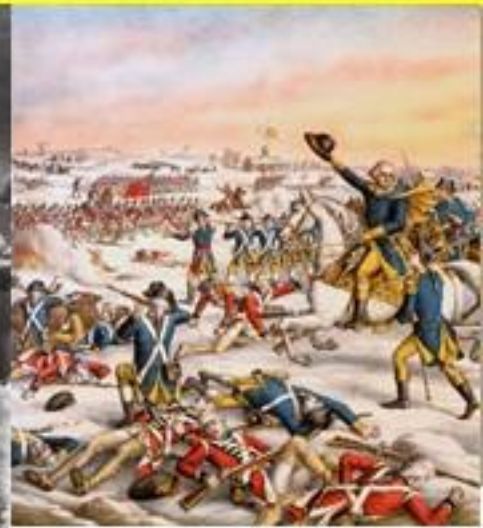


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 18

**THE SOCIALISM AND LABOR
MOVEMENT IN EUROPE - 1**

WHAT ARE THE FACTORS THAT LED TO SOCIALIST MOVEMENTS IN EUROPE?

- 1** The Industrial Revolution in Europe resulted into the paradigm shift in the means of production and production relations.
- 2** The implications of the revolution were phenomenal and influenced nearly all the dimensions of the human lives.
- 3** One of the prominent results of the Industrial Revolution was socio-economic division of the European society on the basis of private property.
- 4** On the basis of ownership rights over the private property, the European society got stratified into Capitalist class and Working class and the revolution gave birth to economic system called Capitalism.



WHAT ARE THE FACTORS THAT LED TO SOCIALIST MOVEMENTS IN EUROPE?

- 5 On the virtue of the concept of the private property the capitalist class maintained its hegemony over the non-possessing class or the working class.
- 6 The concept of private property enabled capitalists, not only to live without working, but also to determine whether the non-owners shall work and under what conditions.
- 7 It established a master and servant relationship, with working class in a disadvantageous position.
- 8 The margin of profit of capitalists depended on the hard labour which the workers put in and less wages which they paid.



WHAT ARE THE FACTORS THAT LED TO SOCIALIST MOVEMENTS IN EUROPE?

- 9 This clash of interests between the two gave rise to class conflict, wherein the interests of capitalist class and the working class were considered to be mutually conflicting.
- 10 Under this system the conditions of the workers became really miserable. None cared for their comforts and the labourers had no security of service.
- 11 Their plight was miserable and neither their life nor honour was secure. The working hours were far more than the wages paid.
- 12 Even the children and women had to work under very odd circumstances. The state paid no heed to them and did not look after their interests.



FLIPSIDE OF CAPITALISM

There were certain inherent defects in the capitalism, which proved to be pivotal in the growth of socialism. The major challenges from which Capitalism suffered are as:

1 PROFIT MOTIVE

- ✓ In the capitalist system the basis of production is not on the needs of majority of people, but the bases production in capitalist system is profit motive.
- ✓ Moreover this profit belongs not to the majority but a handful i.e., capitalists.



2 OWNERSHIP RIGHTS

- ✓ On the basis of ownership over the means of production the capitalists system creates cleavage in the society on the basis of class., the capitalist system makes for a disunited community with one class that works and the other that owns.



FLIPSIDE OF CAPITALISM

3 MONEY & MACHINE

- ✓ Though the production was possible only when the machine and the labour worked maximum attention was paid towards money and the machine rather than the labour.
- ✓ The labourers were living in shanties outside the factories under sub-human conditions, whereas the factory owners, who lived on their labour, resided in beautiful palaces with all the joys and comforts of life. Thus capitalism perpetuated inequality.



FLIPSIDE OF CAPITALISM

4 POPULATION

- ✓ The biggest drawback of the capitalism was the fact that the bulk of population was reduced to penury and destitution.
- ✓ Ironically, the champions of capitalism and early thinkers found nothing wrong in such system and paid no attention to the sad and bad plight of the factory workers.

1 In early nineteenth century, in both England and France, the evils of capitalism were brought before the public through pamphlets, books, and speeches.

2 The thinkers like Robert Owen in England, and Charles Fourier and Comte Henri de Saint Simon in France were the first few thinkers who focused their attention about the sad plight of the factory workers.

3 Their books were widely read, their speeches drew large audiences which criticized capitalism.



WHAT IS SOCIALISM?

- 1** The unifying theme of socialism is the call for social ownership of all nonhuman factors of production- Capital and natural resources.
- 2** It is an economic theory or system in which the means of production, distribution, and exchange are owned by the community collectively, usually through the state.
- 3** It is characterised by production for need rather than profit
 - Equality of individual wealth
 - Absence of competitive economic activity
 - Government determination of investment, prices and production levels.



WHAT IS SOCIALISM?

- 4 In contrast to the capitalism where means of production are controlled and owned by the capitalist class, socialism advocates for means of production to be controlled by the society or community.
- 5 Also in capitalist system where profit is the primary motive for the production, socialism stood for production to be based on satisfying human needs.
- 6 Socialism initially started as a protest movement against the evils perpetuated by capitalism.



WHAT IS SOCIALISM?

- 7** Those who championed the cause of the working class raised their voice to expose the deplorable conditions of the workers and wished to stir and touch the conscience of the factory owners as well as the government to protect the interests of the workers and to provide them basic amenities and facilities, while at work.
- 8** Nonetheless gradually these forces became more vocal and began to consolidate the working class apart from just confining themselves to the demands to improve the work conditions.



WHAT IS SOCIALISM?

- 9 The term socialism connotes a movement which aims at realising the workers about their rights and role which they play in the production.
- 10 The aim of the socialism is that in the profit of workers should get their just and equitable share.
- 11 The ideology envisages that the workers have a right to unite and demand better working conditions.



1 STATE SOCIALISM

During 19th century individualism emerged as an important concept.

- 1 According to this concept, an individual should be the focus round which every state activity should revolve.
- 2 The rights and interests of an individual are supreme and the state should not interfere with private life and property of the individuals.
- 3 The champions of individualism placed individual above the state.
- 4 The state socialism was a staunch reaction against individualism.
- 5 The state socialists on the other hand placed individuals secondary to the state.
- 6 They were of the view that state which is an aggregation of the individuals must be given prominence above the individuals.



WORLD HISTORY

STATE SOCIALISM

Their main points of philosophy were

- 1** They believed in the supremacy of the state. State was considered to be positive good which is necessary for bringing the people out of exploitation.
- 2** The people have the capacity to improve their conditions as members of the state and within the aegis of the state and not outside the state.
- 3** They wish that state activities should be increased so that state becomes welfare state and undertakes maximum welfare activities.



STATE SOCIALISM

- 4 They were bitterly opposed to the capitalist system because in that the means of production are controlled by the few persons and used for their own advantage.
- 5 All means of production should be controlled by the state and used for collective welfare.
- 6 The factories should be allowed by the produce only what is needed by the society. They therefore, favour state controlled industry.
- 7 There should be just distribution of wealth and the state should not allow concentration of wealth just in few hands.



CRITICISM OF STATE SOCIALISM



In nut shell excessive nationalization can result into concentration of both work and authority and that will lead to in-efficiency and delays.

1 It is based on the belief that **social ownership** of the means of production can be **achieved by voluntary and peaceful surrender** of means of production by capitalist class.

2 It is based on the tenet that **collective ownership** eliminates greed and promotes personal growth, cultural enrichment, and democracy.

3 This school of socialism is exemplified in the work of **Henri de Saint-Simon, Charles Fourier and Robert Owen.**



de Saint-Simon



Charles Fourier



Robert Owen

4 The system is based on the premise that if capitalist class voluntarily surrender their rights over means of production to the state or workers the state of workers and their living conditions will improve and poverty would get abolish.

5 A key difference between Utopian socialists and other Socialists is that utopian socialists generally don't feel class struggle or political revolutions are necessary to implement their ideas.

6 They are of the view that people of all classes might voluntarily adopt their plan for society if it were presented convincingly.



CRITICISM OF UTOPIAN SOCIALISM

1 The biggest criticism of Utopian socialism is the fact that voluntary surrender of property rights by capitalist class would surrender property rights without any pressure or conflict.

2 The surrendering of property rights is against the interests of the capitalist class. Therefore voluntary surrender of these rights is only hypothetically possible.



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